

Fountain City Land Services

Operational Pricing Manual & Jobber Setup Guide

Service Area: Kansas City Metro / Spring Hill, KS

Equipment Profile: Tracked Bobcat Skid Steer, Owner-Operator

Effective: 2026 Season · Document Version 1.0

"The right response. Every time."

How To Use This Manual

This document is structured as a single source of truth for pricing, quoting, and selling Fountain City Land Services work. It is organized into ten sections:

Section	Purpose	Audience
1	Master Price Sheet	Internal / Estimator
2	Jobber Pricebook Structure	Office / Setup
3	Quick Quote Matrix	Field / On-site estimating
4	Minimum Charges	Estimator / Customer-facing
5	Profitability Guidance	Owner / Strategy
6	Facebook & Local Marketing	Owner / Marketing
7	Service Bundles	Sales / Customer-facing
8	Attachment Pricing	Internal cost model
9	Residential Customer Language	Customer-facing
10	Operations Notes	Owner / Strategy

All pricing reflects realistic 2026 Kansas City metro market rates for a professional, insured, owner-operated land services contractor. Prices are positioned mid-to-upper-market — not the cheapest, not the most expensive. Numbers assume the operator is targeting a blended job margin of **45–55%** after fuel, wear, transport, dump, and labor.

SECTION 1 — MASTER PRICE SHEET

1.1 Pricing Philosophy

Principle	Detail
Target gross margin	45–55% per job
Target effective hourly	\$165–\$195/hr blended (machine + operator)
Mobilization	Always charged or built in — never absorbed silently
Minimum job	\$450 residential / \$650 rural
Material markup	25–35% over delivered cost
Dump fees	Pass-through + 20% handling
Same-week premium	+15% rush surcharge
Weekend / after-hours	+25–35%

1.2 Hourly & Day Rates (Skid Steer + Operator)

Rate Type	Price	Includes	Notes
Hourly (standard bucket)	\$165/hr	Machine, operator, fuel within 25 mi	2-hr minimum on-site
Hourly (grapple)	\$185/hr	Grapple attachment	Adds wear premium
Hourly (brush cutter)	\$215/hr	Heavy-duty rotary cutter	Includes blade wear
Hourly (Harley rake)	\$225/hr	Power rake / soil conditioner	Highest finish-grade rate
Hourly (stump grinder)	\$235/hr	Skid-steer stump grinder	Plus tooth wear pass-through
Hourly (auger)	\$195/hr	Plus bit size adder	\$25 bit fee per hole class
Hourly (pallet forks)	\$155/hr	Light material handling	Lowest wear attachment
Half day (4 hr)	\$625	Standard bucket	Includes mobilization within 25 mi
Full day (8 hr)	\$1,200	Standard bucket	Includes mobilization within 25 mi
Full day with grapple	\$1,350	Grapple included	
Full day with brush cutter	\$1,575	Cutter included	
Full day with Harley rake	\$1,650	Rake included	

1.3 Mobilization & Transport

Distance from Spring Hill, KS	Mobilization Fee	Notes
0–15 miles	Included in min charge	Olathe, Gardner, Stilwell
15–25 miles	\$85	Overland Park, Lenexa, Louisburg
25–40 miles	\$145	South KC, Lee's Summit, Paola
40–60 miles	\$235	North KC, Independence, Ottawa

Distance from Spring Hill, KS	Mobilization Fee	Notes
60+ miles	\$4.25/mi round trip	Quoted per job
Multi-day on-site (machine stays)	\$185 one-time	Saves repeat transport

1.4 Service Category Pricing — Master Table

#	Service	Unit	Low	Typical	High	Minimum Charge
1	Gravel driveway repair	per ton applied	\$115	\$145	\$185	\$650
2	Gravel spreading (customer-supplied)	per ton	\$45	\$65	\$85	\$450
3	Pothole repair	per pothole	\$75	\$125	\$225	\$450
4	Property cleanup	per hour	\$165	\$185	\$225	\$650
5	Brush pile removal	per pile (pickup-truck size)	\$185	\$275	\$425	\$450
6	Fence line cleanup	per linear foot	\$4.50	\$7.50	\$14	\$750
7	Acreage mowing	per acre	\$145	\$195	\$295	\$450
8	Brush cutting (heavy)	per hour	\$215	\$235	\$275	\$650
9	Stump grinding	per inch diameter	\$5	\$7	\$11	\$185
10	Small tree removal	per tree	\$185	\$385	\$850	\$450
11	Small demolition	per project	\$850	\$2,450	\$6,500	\$850
12	Light grading	per hour	\$165	\$185	\$215	\$650
13	Minor drainage correction	per project	\$650	\$1,450	\$3,200	\$650
14	Storm cleanup	per hour	\$185	\$215	\$275	\$650
15	Material spreading	per ton	\$35	\$55	\$75	\$450
16	Loader work	per hour	\$165	\$185	\$215	\$450
17	Dirt work	per hour	\$175	\$195	\$235	\$650
18	Skid steer hourly (general)	per hour	\$165	\$185	\$215	\$450

1.5 Material Pricing (Delivered & Spread)

Material	Cost basis	Customer price (delivered + spread)	Notes
AB-3 (road base)	\$24–\$32/ton + delivery	\$58–\$72/ton installed	Most common driveway base

Material	Cost basis	Customer price (delivered + spread)	Notes
1" clean rock	\$28–\$36/ton + delivery	\$62–\$78/ton installed	Drainage / French drain
Crushed limestone screenings	\$22–\$30/ton + delivery	\$55–\$68/ton installed	Top dressing
Pea gravel	\$34–\$44/ton + delivery	\$72–\$92/ton installed	Decorative
River rock (1–3")	\$48–\$68/ton + delivery	\$95–\$135/ton installed	Premium decorative
Topsoil (screened)	\$28–\$38/yd + delivery	\$62–\$85/yd spread	Yard restoration
Mulch (bulk)	\$32–\$42/yd + delivery	\$68–\$95/yd spread	Bed installs
Fill dirt	\$14–\$22/yd + delivery	\$42–\$65/yd spread	Low-spot fill

Material markup rule: 25–35% over delivered cost. Always pass through delivery surcharge separately.

1.6 Dump Fees & Disposal

Disposal Type	Customer charge	Notes
Brush/wood (standard)	\$85–\$175 per load	Most rural sites can burn — confirm first
Mixed yard debris	\$125–\$225 per load	Per dump receipt + 20% handling
Dirt/clean fill	\$0–\$95 per load	Often accepted free at fill sites
Concrete/asphalt	\$145–\$285 per load	Concrete recyclers in KC metro
Construction debris	\$185–\$385 per load	Premium tip fees
Tires/appliances	Quoted separately	Special handling

1.7 Premium & Surcharge Schedule

Surcharge	Amount	When Applied
Same-week rush	+15%	Customer requests start within 7 days
48-hour emergency	+25%	Storm or urgent access work
Weekend (Sat)	+20%	Saturday work requested
Sunday / holiday	+35%	Sunday or major holiday
After-hours (after 6 PM)	+20%	Evening work
Severe terrain / slope	+15–25%	Steep, soft, or hazardous ground
Tight access (manual handling)	+15%	Limited skid steer access
Septic / utility risk areas	+10%	Hand-locating required
Permit handling	Cost + \$125	When city permits are required

SECTION 2 — JOBBER PRICEBOOK STRUCTURE

The structure below maps directly into Jobber's "Products & Services" library. Use the **Category** field to organize, the **Service Name** as the line-item label, and the **Internal Notes** as Jobber's internal description (not visible to the customer).

CATEGORY: DRIVEWAY & GRAVEL

Service Name: Gravel Driveway Refresh — Standard **Unit Type:** Per ton (applied) **Suggested Base Price:** \$145/ton **Description (customer-facing):** Professional refresh of existing gravel driveway using AB-3 road base. Includes delivery, spreading, and grading with tracked skid steer for a clean, even finish. **Recommended Add-ons:** Pothole repair, edge re-establishment, light grading **Internal Notes:** Typical residential drive 100–250 ft uses 8–18 tons. Confirm tonnage based on width/depth before quoting. Margin target 50%.

Service Name: Gravel Spread — Customer-Supplied Material **Unit Type:** Per ton **Suggested Base Price:** \$65/ton **Description:** Professional spreading and grading of customer-supplied gravel using a tracked skid steer. Smooth, level finish with proper crown. **Recommended Add-ons:** Light grading, pothole prep **Internal Notes:** Lower-margin work — only book on small jobs or when paired with other services. \$450 minimum.

Service Name: Pothole Repair — Per Pothole **Unit Type:** Each **Suggested Base Price:** \$125 **Description:** Targeted pothole repair using compacted AB-3 base. Cleaned, filled, and graded for a durable patch. **Recommended Add-ons:** Driveway refresh, edge work **Internal Notes:** Bundle 4+ potholes into "Pothole Package." Single-pothole minimum \$185 due to mobilization.

Service Name: Driveway Grading & Reshaping **Unit Type:** Per hour **Suggested Base Price:** \$185/hr **Description:** Reshape and re-crown an existing gravel drive for proper drainage and a smooth ride. **Recommended Add-ons:** Gravel top dressing, drainage correction **Internal Notes:** 2-hr minimum. Most jobs 2–4 hrs. Push gravel-add-on at quote.

CATEGORY: PROPERTY CLEANUP

Service Name: Brush Pile Removal — Standard **Unit Type:** Per pile **Suggested Base Price:** \$275 per pickup-truck-sized pile **Description:** Removal of accumulated brush, limbs, and yard debris using grapple-equipped skid steer. Clean haul-off included. **Recommended Add-ons:** Fence line cleanup, storm debris removal **Internal Notes:** Confirm if customer can burn on-site (rural) — that's pure margin. Pile size verified on-site; reserve right to re-quote.

Service Name: General Property Cleanup **Unit Type:** Per hour (machine + operator) **Suggested Base Price:** \$185/hr **Description:** Skid-steer-assisted cleanup of yard debris, fallen limbs, scrap, and accumulated material. **Recommended Add-ons:** Brush hauling, dump fee **Internal Notes:** Half-day minimum (\$625) recommended unless paired with another service.

Service Name: Storm Cleanup — Emergency Response **Unit Type:** Per hour **Suggested Base Price:** \$215/hr (+ rush surcharges as applicable) **Description:** Rapid response storm debris cleanup. Tree limb removal, access clearing, debris staging or haul-off. **Recommended Add-ons:** Small tree removal, fence line work **Internal Notes:** Always 4-hr minimum. Add 25% emergency surcharge for <48 hr response. Highest urgency = highest margin.

CATEGORY: VEGETATION MANAGEMENT

Service Name: Acreage Mowing — Tall Grass / Pasture **Unit Type:** Per acre **Suggested Base Price:** \$195/acre

Description: Heavy-duty rotary cutting of tall grass, light brush, and overgrown pasture using skid-steer brush cutter. Suitable for grass up to 6 ft. **Recommended Add-ons:** Fence line cleanup, tree edge cleanup **Internal Notes:** \$450 minimum. Hilly/wet acreage +20%. Best margin: 2+ acre flat jobs.

Service Name: Heavy Brush Cutting — Per Hour **Unit Type:** Per hour **Suggested Base Price:** \$235/hr **Description:**

Aggressive brush cutting in dense overgrown areas using heavy-duty cutter attachment. Clears saplings up to 3" diameter.

Recommended Add-ons: Stump grinding follow-up, debris removal **Internal Notes:** Use when acre pricing won't cover density. Always quote site-unseen as range.

Service Name: Fence Line Cleanup **Unit Type:** Per linear foot **Suggested Base Price:** \$7.50/ft **Description:** Restore

fence lines overgrown with brush, vines, and saplings. Cleared to allow fence repair or visibility. **Recommended Add-ons:** Brush haul-off, tree removal at fence corners **Internal Notes:** \$750 minimum. Density-based pricing — refer to Quick Quote Matrix.

CATEGORY: TREE & STUMP

Service Name: Stump Grinding — Standard **Unit Type:** Per inch of diameter (measured at widest point) **Suggested Base Price:** \$7/inch **Description:** Stump ground to 4–6" below grade using skid-steer stump grinder. Chips left on-site or hauled per request. **Recommended Add-ons:** Chip haul-off, soil/seed restoration **Internal Notes:** \$185 minimum per visit. Multi-stump discount: 10% off when 5+ stumps booked together.

Service Name: Small Tree Removal **Unit Type:** Per tree **Suggested Base Price:** \$385 (typical 6–12" trunk, accessible)

Description: Removal of small trees up to 25 ft tall in accessible locations. Includes felling, sectioning, and stacking or haul-off. **Recommended Add-ons:** Stump grinding, brush removal **Internal Notes:** No tall climbing — refer to arborist for trees with overhead hazards or near structures. Skid steer access required.

CATEGORY: GRADING & DIRT WORK

Service Name: Light Grading **Unit Type:** Per hour **Suggested Base Price:** \$185/hr **Description:** Surface grading and leveling for yards, pads, lots, and driveway approaches. **Recommended Add-ons:** Topsoil spread, seed prep **Internal Notes:** 4-hr minimum recommended. Add Harley rake premium (\$225/hr) for finish work.

Service Name: Dirt Work — Excavation & Fill **Unit Type:** Per hour **Suggested Base Price:** \$195/hr **Description:** General dirt work including small excavation, fill, leveling, and pad prep. **Recommended Add-ons:** Material delivery, drainage tie-in **Internal Notes:** Always confirm utility locates (Kansas One-Call) before quoting. \$650 minimum.

Service Name: Minor Drainage Correction **Unit Type:** Per project **Suggested Base Price:** \$1,450 **Description:** Targeted correction of standing-water issues — swale shaping, surface drainage, low-spot fill, or culvert assistance. **Recommended Add-ons:** Material supply, French drain rock **Internal Notes:** Walk site before quoting. Avoid jobs requiring engineered designs. Profitable when paired with grading work.

Service Name: Material Spreading (Mulch / Topsoil / Decorative Rock) **Unit Type:** Per yard or ton **Suggested Base Price:** \$55/ton or \$65/yd **Description:** Bulk material delivery and professional spreading using skid steer. **Recommended Add-ons:** Light grading, edge prep **Internal Notes:** Charge separately for material + spread. Always quote material with markup.

CATEGORY: DEMOLITION

Service Name: Small Demolition — Sheds & Outbuildings **Unit Type:** Per project **Suggested Base Price:** \$1,850 (typical 10x12 shed) **Description:** Demolition and haul-off of sheds, small outbuildings, decks, fences, and accessory structures. **Recommended Add-ons:** Concrete pad removal, site grading **Internal Notes:** Quote on site only. Confirm asbestos-free (for pre-1980 structures). Premium for tight access.

Service Name: Fence Removal **Unit Type:** Per linear foot **Suggested Base Price:** \$6.50/ft (chain-link or wood, standard) **Description:** Removal and haul-off of existing fencing including posts. **Recommended Add-ons:** Site cleanup, regrade **Internal Notes:** Concrete-set posts +\$3/ft. Barbed wire +\$2/ft.

CATEGORY: HOURLY / SKID STEER

Service Name: Skid Steer + Operator (Hourly) **Unit Type:** Per hour **Suggested Base Price:** \$185/hr (standard bucket) **Description:** Tracked skid steer with experienced operator for hourly work. Versatile, productive, and efficient for a wide range of property tasks. **Recommended Add-ons:** Attachment premium, material delivery **Internal Notes:** 2-hr minimum on-site. Quote travel separately. See attachment matrix for upcharge per attachment.

Service Name: Half Day Skid Steer **Unit Type:** Flat (4 hours) **Suggested Base Price:** \$625 **Description:** Half-day skid steer service — ideal for medium cleanup, grading, or material spreading projects. **Recommended Add-ons:** Attachment upgrade, material **Internal Notes:** Mobilization included within 25 mi.

Service Name: Full Day Skid Steer **Unit Type:** Flat (8 hours) **Suggested Base Price:** \$1,200 **Description:** Full-day skid steer service for larger property projects. **Recommended Add-ons:** Attachment upgrade, dump fee **Internal Notes:** Best margin — sell aggressively. Mobilization included within 25 mi.

SECTION 3 — QUICK QUOTE MATRIX

A field-ready estimating reference. Use these tables in the truck or on-site for fast, defensible pricing.

3.1 Gravel Driveway Refresh (AB-3, 2" depth, 10 ft wide)

Drive Length	Tonnage Estimate	Material Cost (you)	Customer Price (typical)
50 ft	4–5 tons	\$130–\$175	\$650 (minimum)
100 ft	8–10 tons	\$260–\$350	\$1,150–\$1,450
150 ft	12–15 tons	\$390–\$525	\$1,650–\$2,150
200 ft	16–20 tons	\$520–\$700	\$2,150–\$2,850
300 ft	24–30 tons	\$780–\$1,050	\$3,150–\$4,300
500 ft	40–50 tons	\$1,300–\$1,750	\$5,200–\$7,200
1,000 ft	80–100 tons	\$2,600–\$3,500	\$10,400–\$14,500

Rule of thumb: Multiply length (ft) × 0.08 to estimate tons for a 10-ft, 2"-deep refresh. Add 20% for 12-ft drives. Add 50% for full rebuild (4" depth).

3.2 Acreage Mowing — By Acres & Density

Acres	Light grass	Tall grass / pasture	Heavy brush
0.5	\$450 (min)	\$450 (min)	\$650 (min)
1	\$175	\$235	\$385
2	\$325	\$425	\$725
3	\$475	\$625	\$1,050
5	\$775	\$1,050	\$1,725
10	\$1,450	\$1,975	\$3,250
20	\$2,750	\$3,750	\$6,250

3.3 Fence Line Cleanup — By Density

Fence Line Length	Light overgrowth (\$/ft)	Medium overgrowth (\$/ft)	Heavy/saplings (\$/ft)
0–250 ft	\$4.50 (\$750 min)	\$7.50 (\$750 min)	\$14 (\$750 min)
250–500 ft	\$4.50	\$7.50	\$14
500–1,000 ft	\$4.25	\$7.00	\$13
1,000–2,500 ft	\$3.95	\$6.50	\$12
2,500+ ft	Quote on-site	Quote on-site	Quote on-site

Density definitions: - **Light:** Grass, vines, small woody growth <1" diameter - **Medium:** Mixed brush with woody growth up to 2" diameter - **Heavy:** Saplings 2–3" diameter, dense undergrowth

3.4 Stump Grinding — By Diameter

Stump Diameter	Price	Notes
Up to 6"	\$185 (min)	Minimum visit charge
8"	\$185	
12"	\$185	
18"	\$215	\$7 × 18 = \$126 → bumped to bracket
24"	\$285	
30"	\$355	
36"	\$425	
48"	\$565	
60"+	Quote on-site	Multi-pass or large grinder needed

Multi-stump discount: 5+ stumps in one visit = 10% off total. 10+ stumps = 15% off.

3.5 Small Demolition — By Structure Type

Structure	Typical Price	Notes
8x10 shed (no concrete)	\$850–\$1,250	Half-day work
10x12 shed	\$1,450–\$2,250	Most common
12x16 shed	\$2,250–\$3,500	Often full day
20x20 detached garage	\$4,500–\$7,500	Quote on-site
Wood deck (10x12)	\$850–\$1,650	+ dump
Wood deck (15x20)	\$1,650–\$2,950	+ dump
Chain-link fence (per ft)	\$5.50–\$7.50	Includes haul-off
Wood privacy fence (per ft)	\$6.50–\$9.50	Includes haul-off
Concrete pad (4" thick, per sq ft)	\$4–\$8	+ dump fee

3.6 Brush Pile Removal — By Pile Size

Pile Size	Price (haul-off)	Price (push/burn on-site rural)
Pickup-truck size	\$275	\$185 (min)
Single-axle dump load	\$475	\$325
Tandem dump load	\$850	\$585
Multi-load / debris field	Quote on-site	Quote on-site

3.7 Tree Removal — By Trunk Diameter (small trees, accessible)

Trunk Diameter	Price Range	Notes
Up to 6"	\$185–\$285	Small saplings, multi-tree discount
6–10"	\$285–\$485	Standard small tree

Trunk Diameter	Price Range	Notes
10–14"	\$485–\$725	Most common quote
14–18"	\$725–\$1,150	Push-over candidates if open
18–24"	\$1,150–\$1,850	Borderline — refer if hazardous
24"+ or near structures	Refer to climbing arborist	Outside scope

3.8 Pothole Repair Packages

Package	Holes	Price	Notes
Single	1	\$185 (min)	Mobilization-driven
Small	2–4	\$450	Most common residential
Medium	5–10	\$850	Half-day equivalent
Large	11–20	\$1,450	Includes light grading touch-up
Driveway-wide	20+	Refer to "Driveway Refresh" instead	

SECTION 4 — MINIMUM CHARGES

4.1 Minimum Charge Schedule

Job Type	Minimum	Rationale
Residential small job	\$450	Covers transport, fuel, 2 hrs operator
Rural / acreage small job	\$650	Longer travel, larger machine setup
Single pothole	\$185	One-stop visit, paired or solo
Single stump	\$185	Same — visit-driven
Half-day rate	\$625	4 hrs on-site + mobilization
Full-day rate	\$1,200	8 hrs on-site + mobilization
Emergency / 48-hr response	\$750	Plus 25% rush surcharge
Weekend (Saturday)	+20% to base	Premium for non-standard day
Sunday / holiday	+35% to base	Discourage unless premium-priced
After-hours (after 6 PM)	+20%	

4.2 Travel & Transport Charges

Scenario	Charge	Notes
Within 25 miles of Spring Hill	Included in minimum	Olathe, Gardner, OP, Lenexa, Stilwell
25–40 mi	\$145 mobilization	Lee's Summit, Paola, south KC
40–60 mi	\$235 mobilization	Independence, Ottawa, Belton
60+ mi	\$4.25/mile round trip	Quoted per job
Multi-day machine on-site	\$185 flat	Reduces repeat transport
Trailer-only delivery (no operator)	Not offered	Avoid liability

4.3 Why Minimums Matter (Internal Note)

Mobilization eats 1.0–1.5 hours per job before a single dollar of productive work happens. A \$185 "small job" with 45 min of round-trip transport plus 30 min of setup nets less than \$80/hr at the machine. **Never go below the published minimums.** If the customer pushes back, offer to bundle with a neighbor or wait until you're in the area.

SECTION 5 — PROFITABILITY GUIDANCE

5.1 Margin & Cash Flow Matrix

Service	Gross Margin	Cash Flow Speed	Repeat Potential	FB Sellability	Recommended Priority
Gravel driveway repair	High (50–60%)	Fast	High (yearly)	Excellent	#1 — Lead service
Pothole repair	Very High (60–70%)	Very fast	High	Excellent	#2 — Easy yes
Stump grinding	Very High (60–70%)	Very fast	Medium	Strong	#3 — High margin
Brush pile removal	High (55–65%)	Fast	Medium	Excellent	Strong starter
Acreage mowing	Medium (40–50%)	Fast	High (recurring)	Strong	Recurring revenue
Fence line cleanup	High (50–60%)	Medium	Low (one-time)	Strong	Project work
Storm cleanup	Very High (65–75%)	Very fast	Event-driven	Excellent	Surge revenue
Small tree removal	Medium-High (45–55%)	Fast	Low	Strong	Bundle with stump
Property cleanup	Medium (40–50%)	Medium	Medium	Strong	Volume play
Light grading	Medium-High (45–55%)	Medium	Low-Medium	Medium	Pair with material
Dirt work	Medium (40–50%)	Medium	Low	Medium	Bigger ticket
Drainage correction	Medium (40–50%)	Medium-slow	Low	Weak	Project / referral
Small demolition	Medium-High (45–55%)	Medium	Low	Medium	Bigger ticket
Material spreading	Low-Medium (30–40%)	Fast	Medium	Weak	Bundle only
Hourly skid steer	Medium (40–50%)	Fast	Medium	Medium	Filler work

5.2 Highest Margin Services (rank order)

1. **Storm cleanup (emergency)** — surge pricing + urgency
2. **Pothole repair** — small material cost, premium pricing
3. **Stump grinding** — single-attachment, high \$/hr
4. **Brush pile removal (rural, on-site burn)** — no dump fee
5. **Gravel driveway refresh** — material markup + machine time

5.3 Fastest Cash Flow

1. **Pothole repair** — quote, do, paid same day
2. **Brush pile removal** — half-day in-and-out
3. **Stump grinding** — fixed-bid, paid on completion
4. **Storm cleanup** — invoiced immediately
5. **Driveway refresh** — typically paid within 48 hrs

5.4 Easiest to Sell on Facebook

1. Driveway refresh ("before / after" photos win)

2. Pothole repair (urgency-driven, neighbor pile-on)
3. Brush pile removal (every rural homeowner has one)
4. Storm cleanup (after weather events)
5. Acreage mowing (spring & late summer)

5.5 Best Repeat-Client Services

1. **Acreage mowing** — 2–4 cuts per season per property
2. **Driveway maintenance** — annual refresh
3. **Property cleanup** — seasonal spring/fall
4. **Pothole repair** — 1–2x per year on long drives
5. **Brush management** — recurring on rural acreage

5.6 Services to Avoid (Early Stage)

Service	Why to avoid early
Engineered drainage projects	Liability, often requires permits, slow-paying
Large demolition with concrete	Dump fees + heavy wear, narrow margin
Tree removal near structures	Insurance & climbing scope — refer out
Customer-supplied gravel spread (solo)	Low margin unless paired
Bid jobs against landscapers	Race to the bottom
Snow removal (commercial contracts)	High commitment, equipment risk
Large excavation requiring multiple machines	One-machine operator can't compete

5.7 Job Sizing — Margin Cliff

A practical truth for an owner-operator: **profit per day, not per job**. A \$1,200 day with a single customer beats three \$450 jobs across three locations every time. Stack jobs geographically, push half-day and full-day bookings, and use minimums to filter low-value calls.

SECTION 6 — FACEBOOK / LOCAL MARKETING STRATEGY

6.1 Recommended First-Push Services (Residential)

- 1. **Gravel driveway refresh** — universal need, visible result
- 2. **Pothole repair** — fast, low-friction yes
- 3. **Brush pile removal** — every rural homeowner needs it
- 4. **Storm cleanup** — react to weather events
- 5. **Acreage mowing** — recurring revenue base

6.2 Best Lead Generation Angles

Angle	Wording theme	Why it works
Local + responsive	"Spring Hill / South KC owner-operated"	Local trust + fast response
Before / after	Photo-led posts of completed work	Visible proof
Neighorly	"Got a brush pile? We probably drive past your road."	Hyper-local relevance
Seasonal urgency	"Storm season starts soon — get your drive solid first."	Time-bound action
Done-right	"Ten tons spread right beats twenty tons dumped wrong."	Quality positioning

6.3 Suggested Wording Patterns

- "Owner-operated. Insured. Local."
- "The right response. Every time."
- "We answer the phone. We show up. We get it done."
- "Tracked Bobcat work — driveways, brush, dirt, cleanup."
- "Spring Hill / Olathe / Louisburg / South KC."
- "Free quotes. Honest pricing. No surprises."

6.4 Example Facebook Post Captions

Driveway Refresh (Photo Post)

8 tons of AB-3 spread, graded, and crowned this morning in Stilwell. 200-ft drive that hadn't been touched in 4 years — now smooth from the road to the house. We do this work right, and we do it local. Free quotes. Drop a comment or DM. Fountain City Land Services — Spring Hill, KS

Pothole Repair (Quick Win Post)

Five potholes on a long rural drive in Louisburg — handled in under two hours. AB-3, compacted, blended. Drive looks like itself again. If your drive is rattling your truck, we can fix that this week. Fountain City Land Services — owner-operated, insured, local.

Brush Pile Removal (Rural Homeowner Post)

That brush pile from the storm cleanup last fall? We can have it gone this Saturday. Tracked Bobcat with grapple, in and out. Spring Hill, Paola, Louisburg, and surrounding. Message for a quick quote.

Storm Response Post (Reactive)

Lots of limbs and downed trees across the south metro after last night. We're on the road today helping get driveways and yards clear. If you've got debris, message us — we'll get back same day. Fountain City Land Services. The right response. Every time.

Acreage Mowing (Spring Push Post)

Pasture getting away from you? Heavy-duty rotary cutter on the Bobcat handles 5-foot grass and saplings up to 3". One pass, clean finish. Booking spring mowing now for properties 1–20 acres in the Spring Hill / Miami County area.

Bundle Promo Post (Periodic)

Spring Property Refresh: driveway gravel + pothole repair + brush pile haul-off — bundled and discounted. Most rural properties handled in a single day. Free quote, no pressure.

6.5 Recommended Seasonal Services

Season	Lead Services	Marketing Angle
Late winter / early spring	Driveway refresh, pothole repair, drainage fixes	"Get ahead of the spring rains"
Spring	Acreage mowing, brush cleanup, fence line, property cleanup	"Reclaim the property"
Summer	Brush cutting, fence line, mowing rotation, light grading	"Mid-season knock-down"
Late summer	Second mowing, brush re-cut, storm prep	"Storm season prep"
Fall	Property cleanup, brush hauling, gravel before freeze, stump grinding	"Lock it down before winter"
Winter	Stump grinding (frozen ground), small demo, planning quotes	"Winter rates available"

6.6 Local Marketing Tactics (Beyond Facebook)

- **Yard signs** at every completed job (with permission) — \$35 each, pays for itself in 1 lead.
- **Door hangers** within ½-mile radius of each completed job after the work is done.
- **Local Facebook groups** — Spring Hill, Louisburg, Paola, Stilwell, Gardner community pages.
- **Nextdoor** — owner-operated angle plays well; respond fast to "need a guy who..." posts.
- **Google Business Profile** — photos updated weekly; ask every happy customer for a review.
- **Truck/trailer wrap** — rolling billboard in the service area.

SECTION 7 — SERVICE BUNDLES

Bundles drive larger ticket sizes, simplify quoting, and create clear marketing offers. Each bundle is priced at a modest discount vs. à la carte (5–10%) to reward booking the full package.

7.1 Rural Property Cleanup Package

What's included: - Up to 2 brush piles removed (pickup-truck size) - 3 hours skid steer with grapple - Light fence-line touch-up (up to 200 ft) - Property debris haul-off (1 trailer load)

À la carte total: \$1,650 **Bundle price:** **\$1,495** **Notes:** Most popular rural offering. Half- to full-day on-site. Excellent FB-marketable bundle.

7.2 Driveway Refresh Package

What's included: - Up to 12 tons AB-3 delivered & spread - Pothole repair (up to 6 holes) - Light grading & re-crown - Edge re-establishment

À la carte total: \$2,250 **Bundle price:** **\$1,995** **Notes:** Lead bundle for residential. Photographs beautifully. Upsell more tonnage in \$145/ton increments.

7.3 Fence Line Recovery Package

What's included: - Up to 500 linear feet of fence line cleared (medium density) - Brush haul-off or push-to-burn-pile - Corner tree/stump prep (up to 3 stumps under 12") - 1 hour finish-grade touch-up

À la carte total: \$4,650 **Bundle price:** **\$4,250** **Notes:** Project-style sale. Often paired with new fence install by a fencing contractor — partner referral opportunity.

7.4 Storm Cleanup Package

What's included: - 6 hours skid steer with grapple - Up to 3 brush piles consolidated/removed - 1 small tree removal (up to 12" trunk, accessible) - Driveway clearing & access restoration

À la carte total: \$2,150 **Bundle price:** **\$1,950** **Notes:** Reactive, post-event sale. 25% emergency surcharge applied if booked within 48 hrs of event. Margin king.

7.5 Acreage Maintenance Package (Seasonal Plan)

What's included (per visit): - Up to 5 acres rotary mowing - Fence-line touch-up (up to 250 ft) - One brush pile pushed/cleared

Per-visit price: \$1,375 **3-visit seasonal plan:** **\$3,750** (saves \$375) **Notes:** Recurring revenue base. Collect 1/3 deposit at signing. Schedule visits ~10 weeks apart May–October.

7.6 Bundle Pricing Cheat Sheet

Bundle	Bundle Price	Approx. Savings	Best For
Rural Property Cleanup	\$1,495	\$155	Rural homeowners
Driveway Refresh	\$1,995	\$255	Long residential drives
Fence Line Recovery	\$4,250	\$400	Pre-fence repair customers
Storm Cleanup	\$1,950	\$200	Post-storm reactive sales

Bundle	Bundle Price	Approx. Savings	Best For
Acreage Maintenance (3-visit)	\$3,750	\$375	2–10 acre owners

SECTION 8 — ATTACHMENT PRICING

8.1 Attachment Hourly & Day Rates

Attachment	Hourly Rate	Half Day (4 hr)	Full Day (8 hr)	Wear Premium / Notes
Standard bucket	\$165/hr	\$625	\$1,200	Baseline; lowest wear
Pallet forks	\$155/hr	\$585	\$1,125	Lowest wear; light load only
Grapple bucket	\$185/hr	\$695	\$1,350	Higher wear on cylinders/teeth
Auger	\$195/hr + \$25/hole bit fee	\$735	\$1,425	Bit wear; charge bit fee per diameter class
Brush cutter (rotary)	\$215/hr	\$815	\$1,575	High blade wear; \$35/hr blade reserve
Harley rake (power rake)	\$225/hr	\$850	\$1,650	Premium finish work; tine wear
Land leveler	\$195/hr	\$735	\$1,425	Medium wear
Stump grinder	\$235/hr + tooth pass-through	\$895	\$1,725	High tooth wear; track replacements
Forestry mulcher (future, owned)	\$295/hr	\$1,125	\$2,150	Premium service; fuel-heavy
Forestry mulcher (rented)	Cost + 35% mark-up	—	—	See Section 10 — rent before owning

8.2 Wear & Fuel Considerations

Attachment	Fuel Burn (gph)	Wear Reserve / hr	Internal Cost Note
Standard bucket	2.5–3.0	\$5	Low — baseline
Pallet forks	2.0–2.5	\$3	Lowest
Grapple	2.8–3.2	\$8	Cylinders, teeth
Auger	3.0–3.5	\$12 + bits	Bit fee separate
Brush cutter	4.5–5.5	\$25	Blades + spindle
Harley rake	3.5–4.0	\$15	Tines, bearings
Stump grinder	4.0–5.0	\$30 + teeth	Highest variable cost
Forestry mulcher	5.5–6.5	\$45	Highest wear & fuel

Internal rule: Charge enough per attachment hour to fund replacement. A stump grinder with \$30/hr wear plus tooth pass-through must bill at \$235/hr+ to be sustainable.

8.3 When to Add an Attachment Premium

- **Always** disclose attachment in quote (transparency builds trust).
- **Always** apply attachment hourly rate, not standard rate, when that attachment is the primary tool.

- **Bundle attachments** in day rates (e.g., "Brush cutter day = \$1,575") — easier to sell than itemizing.
-

SECTION 9 — RESIDENTIAL CUSTOMER LANGUAGE

Customer-facing wording that sounds professional, approachable, and clear. Use these as templates in Jobber quotes, follow-up emails, and texts.

9.1 Estimate Language (Top of Quote)

Thanks for reaching out to Fountain City Land Services. Below is your estimate based on the information provided and our walk-through of the property. Pricing reflects professional, insured, owner-operated work with a tracked Bobcat skid steer and the appropriate attachment for the job.

All work includes mobilization, fuel, operator time, and clean job-site finish. Material and dump fees, if any, are listed separately so you can see exactly what you're paying for.

Quotes are valid for 30 days. Schedule fills quickly during peak season — let us know when you'd like to lock in a date.

9.2 Material Pricing Explanation

Material is priced at our delivered cost plus a small handling and spreading fee. Bulk gravel, topsoil, and mulch costs vary by supplier and season — we'll always confirm the final tonnage and price with you before delivery.

If you'd prefer to source the material yourself, we're glad to spread customer-supplied material at our reduced spreading rate. Either way, we'll tell you up front what makes the most sense for your project.

9.3 Weather Delay Language

Weather is the one thing we can't control. If conditions on the scheduled day are unsafe for the operator, harmful to your property (saturated ground, ruts, runoff), or below the quality we deliver, we'll reach out to reschedule — usually for the next available dry window.

We never charge a fee for weather rescheduling. If the delay impacts your project timeline, just let us know and we'll do our best to fit you in.

9.4 Change Order Language

If the scope of work changes once we're on-site — additional gravel, more brush than expected, an extra stump, etc. — we'll stop, walk you through the change, and confirm the additional pricing before any work continues. You always know what you're paying for.

Changes are documented in writing (text or email) and added to the final invoice.

9.5 Property Protection Language

We treat your property like it's our own. Our tracked skid steer is gentler on lawns than a wheeled machine, but heavy equipment always carries some risk of turf marking — especially when the ground is soft. We minimize damage by working off plywood, pulling tracks straight, and avoiding wet conditions when possible.

Any unavoidable turf marking is noted before we leave, and most lawns recover within one mowing cycle. We are not responsible for damage to underground utilities, irrigation, or invisible fencing that has not been marked or disclosed prior to work.

9.6 Scope Limitations Language

A few things we want to be straightforward about up front:

- We do **not** climb trees or remove trees near structures or utility lines — we'll happily refer you to a trusted local arborist.
- We do **not** perform engineered drainage, retaining walls, or work requiring stamped plans.
- We do **not** handle hazardous materials, asbestos, or contaminated soil.
- We work within Kansas One-Call utility locate guidelines — we'll request locates when required, and we won't dig until they're complete.

If your project falls outside our scope, we'll tell you on the first call. No pressure, no upsell.

9.7 Booking & Payment Language

Once you've approved your estimate, a signed quote and 25% deposit (jobs over \$1,500) reserves your spot on the schedule. Payment in full is due upon completion — we accept card, ACH, check, or cash.

For repeat customers and seasonal accounts, we're happy to set up Net-15 invoicing.

9.8 Closing / Thank You Language

Thanks for trusting Fountain City Land Services with your property. If you're happy with the work, a quick Google review or a friendly word to a neighbor is the best compliment we can get. If anything wasn't right, let us know first — we'll make it right.

— The right response. Every time.

SECTION 10 — OPERATIONS NOTES

10.1 Rent vs. Buy — Attachment Decision Framework

Attachment	Rent Until...	Buy When...	Notes
Standard bucket	Owned from day 1	—	Required core
Grapple	Day 1 if budget allows; otherwise rent first	Booking ≥6 grapple jobs/month	High-utility — buy early
Pallet forks	Owned by month 6	Material handling becomes routine	Cheap to own
Brush cutter	Rent first season	Booking ≥3 brush jobs/month	\$7–10K to own; rents at \$250/day
Stump grinder	Rent first season	Booking ≥2 stump jobs/week	Tooth wear is brutal — verify margin holds
Auger	Rent per project until needed monthly	4+ post-hole jobs per month	Bits are \$400–800 each
Harley rake	Rent until finish-grade work is ≥10% of revenue	Buy when seeding/lawn-prep work hits steady volume	Premium attachment
Land leveler	Rent until needed regularly	Steady gravel-drive work	Often substituted by bucket back-drag
Forestry mulcher	Rent only — for years	Only when you're booked 100+ hrs/yr at \$295/hr	\$35–55K attachment, \$20K+ wear/yr

Rule: If you rent an attachment 4+ times in a season, run the math on owning. Below that, the rental margin is yours to keep without the capital tied up.

10.2 Best Starter Services (First 90 Days)

Focus capacity on jobs that are **fast, profitable, and visible**:

1. Driveway refresh (your "hero" service)
2. Pothole repair (high-margin, easy yes)
3. Brush pile removal (every rural lead has one)
4. Stump grinding (premium per-hour rate)
5. Property cleanup (volume + repeat)

Avoid early: complex drainage, large demo, tree removal near structures, anything requiring permits.

10.3 Best ROI Services (Long Term)

Service	Why it wins
Driveway refresh & maintenance	High repeat, photo-friendly, premium pricing, low risk
Acreage mowing (recurring)	Predictable seasonal revenue, low complexity
Storm cleanup	Surge pricing, fast cash, reactive sales
Stump grinding	High \$/hr, low capital after grinder is paid off

Service	Why it wins
Bundled property packages	Higher ticket, easier upsell, fewer mobilizations

10.4 Best Attachment Investments (Order of Priority)

1. **Grapple bucket** — used on nearly every cleanup and brush job
2. **Pallet forks** — cheap, useful for material handling
3. **Brush cutter** — second season after volume confirms
4. **Stump grinder** — buy when stump volume justifies (high wear)
5. **Harley rake** — when finish-grade work becomes regular
6. **Forestry mulcher** — last; rent for years before owning

10.5 How to Avoid Underbidding

Trap	How to avoid
"I'll just throw a number out"	Always walk the site or request photos/measurements
Forgetting mobilization	Build into minimum charge or itemize
Ignoring dump fees	Always confirm disposal route before quoting
Underestimating brush density	Pad density-based jobs by 15%
Forgetting wear/fuel premium per attachment	Use Section 8 rates — never standard \$165/hr
Quoting too fast on phone	Provide a <i>range</i> ; firm up after walk-through
Matching a lowball competitor	Walk away; you can't out-cheap a guy with no insurance
Not building in reschedule risk	Quote per-job, not per-day-on-calendar
Forgetting to account for traffic / load times	Add 30 min buffer per material trip
Volume discounts that destroy margin	Cap discounts at 10–15%; never bundle below 40% margin

10.6 Daily Profitability Checklist (Owner)

Before every job: - ☐ Quote in writing, signed, deposit collected if over \$1,500 - ☐ Material confirmed with supplier (price + delivery window) - ☐ Locates called if any digging - ☐ Right attachment loaded - ☐ Fuel topped, grease points hit, tracks checked - ☐ Job folder in Jobber set to "In Progress"

After every job: - ☐ Final walk-through with customer - ☐ Photos for portfolio + FB - ☐ Yard sign placed (with permission) - ☐ Invoice sent same day - ☐ Review request sent within 48 hrs - ☐ Job costs entered in Jobber for true margin tracking

10.7 Pricing Review Cadence

Frequency	What to review
Weekly	Win/loss rate on quotes; adjust if winning >80% (too cheap) or <30% (too high)
Monthly	Attachment utilization; rent-vs-buy thresholds
Quarterly	Material pricing (suppliers shift)
Annually	Full price sheet refresh; surcharge schedule; minimums

10.8 Insurance, Compliance & Risk

- **General liability**: \$1M minimum; carry \$2M aggregate by year 2.
- **Inland marine** on the skid steer + attachments.

- **Auto / commercial trailer** coverage.
 - **W-9 / COI** ready to send within 1 hour of any commercial customer request.
 - **Kansas One-Call** before any digging, every time.
 - **Photo documentation** of pre-existing damage before starting any sensitive job (lawns, near septic, near structures).
-

CLOSING NOTE

This manual is a living document. Update prices as fuel, materials, and your own efficiency change. The single biggest profitability lever isn't price — it's **routing jobs tightly geographically, selling bundles, and enforcing minimums without apology.**

Premium positioning isn't about being expensive. It's about being the contractor who answers the phone, shows up when promised, prices honestly, and finishes clean. Price like the operator that customers tell their neighbors about — because that's the customer base that compounds.

Fountain City Land Services — The right response. Every time.